

Sliding Window →

↳ In many problem dealing with an array (or a linked list), we are asked to find or calculate something among all the contiguous subarray (or sublists) of given size.

1) Subarray / Sublist

↳ is a contiguous part of an array or lists.

↳ Order is preserved.

2) Subsequence

↳ A subsequence is a sequence derived by deleting some (or no) element, without changing the order.

↳ Element do not need to be contiguous.

3) Subset

↳ A Subset refer to any combination of elements.

↳ Often used in set theory.

1) Avg of all Contiguous subArray of size 'K' in it.

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
```

```
class AverageOfSubarrayOfSizeK {
```

```
    vector<double> findAverages(int K, vector<int> &arr) {
```

```
        vector<double> result();
```

```
        double windowSum = 0;
```

```
        int windowStart = 0;
```

```
        for(int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < arr.size(); windowEnd++) {
```

```
            windowSum += arr[windowEnd];
```

```
            if(windowEnd >= K-1) {
```

→ this will cause segmentation fault

```
                result.push_back  
                (windowSum / K);
```

← use

```
                result[windowStart] = windowSum / K;
```



```

        windowSum -= arr[windowStart];
        windowStart++;
    }
}
return result;
}
};

```

Problem - Max Sub Array of Size K

Problem Statement

Given an array of positive numbers and a positive number 'k', find the maximum sum of any contiguous subarray of size 'k'.

Example 1:

```

Input: [2, 1, 5, 1, 3, 2], k=3
Output: 9
Explanation: Subarray with maximum sum is [5, 1, 3].

```

Example 2:

```

Input: [2, 3, 4, 1, 5], k=2
Output: 7
Explanation: Subarray with maximum sum is [3, 4].

```

Try it yourself

Try solving this question here:

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
int findMaxSumSubArray(int k, vector<int> &arr){
```

```
    int windowSum = 0;
```

```
    int maxSum = 0;
```

```
    int windowStart = 0;
```

```
    for (int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < arr.size(); windowEnd++) {
```

```
        windowSum += arr[windowEnd];
```

```
        if (windowEnd >= k-1) {
```

```
            maxSum = max(maxSum, windowSum);
```

```
            windowSum -= arr[windowStart];
```

```
            windowStart++;
```

```
        }
```

```
    }
```



```

        return maxSum;
    }
};

```

Problem - Smallest subarray with a given sum →

Problem Statement

Given an array of positive numbers and a positive number 'S', find the length of the smallest contiguous subarray whose sum is greater than or equal to 'S'. Return 0, if no such subarray exists.

Example 1:

Input: [2, 1, 5, 2, 3, 2], S=7

Output: 2

Explanation: The smallest subarray with a sum greater than or equal to '7' is [5, 2].

```

#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std;

```

```

int findMinSubArray(int S, vector<int> &arr) {
    int windowSum = 0;
    minLength = numeric_limits<int>::max();
    int windowStart = 0;
    for (int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < arr.size(); windowEnd++) {
        windowSum += arr[windowEnd];

        while (windowSum >= S) {
            minLength = min(minLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1);
            windowSum -= arr[windowStart];
            windowStart++;
        }
    }

    return minLength == numeric_limits<int>::max() ? 0 : minLength;
}

```


when to use if inside while

↳ when you only need to check once whether the window is valid i.e. that the condition (e.g. size, sum, character count) rarely breaks & doesn't need multiple consecutive shrinking

when to use while inside while

↳ when you repeatedly shrink the window until it becomes valid again.

↳ This happens in problems where you must enforce a strict constraint (like $\text{sum} \leq K$, $\text{unique char} \leq K$).

Problem → Longest Substring with K Distinct Characters →

Given a string, find the length of the longest substring in it with no more than K distinct characters.

Example 1:

Input: String="araaci", K=2
Output: 4
Explanation: The longest substring with no more than '2' distinct characters is "aaaa".

Example 2:

Input: String="araaci", K=1
Output: 2
Explanation: The longest substring with no more than '1' distinct characters is "aa".

Example 3:

? Ask Yourself

↳ Do I need to track count or occurrences of element in the window?

↳ if yes then you likely need a hash map.

Common Scenarios →

count of distinct element in window

→ You need to track frequency of each element.

character frequency match (like anagram)

→ You must match the exact freq

Tracking the first or last occurrence of a character

→ Need to map element to positions.

Maintaining a sliding window of constraints like "at most k distinct characters"

You need to know how many unique elements are in the current window

Problems involving substring with constraints (eg, "Longest substring without repeating characters")

You need to track if a character has already appeared in the window

```
#include <iostream / stdc++.h>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
int findLength( string s, int k ) {
```

```
    int windowStart = 0;
```

```
    int maxLength = 0;
```

```
    unordered_map<char, int> charFrequencyMap;
```

```
    for( int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < s.size(); windowEnd++ ) {
```

```
        char rightChar = s[windowEnd];
```

```
        charFrequencyMap[ rightChar ]++;
```

```
        while ( charFrequencyMap.size() > k ) {
```

```
            char leftChar = s[windowStart];
```

```
            charFrequencyMap[ leftChar ]--;
```

```
            if ( charFrequencyMap[ rightChar ] == 0 ) {
```

```
                charFrequencyMap.erase( leftChar );
```

```
            }
```

```
            windowStart++;
```

```
        }
```

```
        maxLength = max( maxLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1 );
```

```
    }
```



```

    }
    return maxLength;
}

```

Problem - Fruits into Baskets.

Problem Statement

Given an array of characters where each character represents a fruit tree, you are given **two baskets** and your goal is to put **maximum number of fruits in each basket**. The only restriction is that **each basket can have only one type of fruit**.

You can start with any tree, but once you have started you can't skip a tree. You will pick one fruit from each tree until you cannot, i.e., you will stop when you have to pick from a third fruit type.

Write a function to return the maximum number of fruits in both the baskets.

Example 1:

```

Input: Fruit=['A', 'B', 'C', 'A', 'C']
Output: 3
Explanation: We can put 2 'C' in one basket and one 'A' in the other from the subarray ['C', 'A', 'C']

```

Example 2:

```

Input: Fruit=['A', 'B', 'C', 'B', 'B', 'C']
Output: 5
Explanation: We can put 3 'B' in one basket and two 'C' in the other basket. This can be done if we start with the second letter: ['B', 'C', 'B', 'B', 'C']

```

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
int findLength(vector<int> &arr) {
```

```
    int windowStart = 0;
```

```
    int maxLength = 0;
```

```
    unordered_map<char, int> fruitFrequencyMap;
```

```
    for (int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < arr.size(); windowEnd++) {
```

```
        fruitFrequencyMap[arr[windowEnd]]++;
```

```
        while (fruitFrequencyMap.size() > 2) {
```

```
            fruitFrequencyMap[arr[windowStart]]--;
```

```
            if (fruitFrequencyMap[arr[windowStart]] == 0) {
```

```
                fruitFrequencyMap.erase(arr[windowStart]);
```

```
            }
```

```
            windowStart++;
```



```

    }
    maxLength = max(maxLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1);
}
return maxLength;
}

```

→ Similar Problems
(Longest Substrings with at most 2 distinct characters).

Problem - No - repeat Substring

Given a string, find the length of the longest substring which has no repeating characters.

Example 1:

```

Input: String="aabccbb"
Output: 3
Explanation: The longest substring without any repeating characters is "abc".

```

Example 2:

```

Input: String="abbbb"
Output: 2
Explanation: The longest substring without any repeating characters is "ab".

```

Example 3:

```

Input: String="abcde"
Output: 3
Explanation: Longest substrings without any repeating characters are "abc" & "cde".

```

Try it yourself #

Try solving this question here:

```

#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std;

```

```

int findLength(string &str) {

```

```

    int windowStart = 0;

```

```

    int maxLength = 0;

```

```

    unordered_map<char, int> charIndexMap;

```

```

    for (int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < str.size(); windowEnd++) {

```

```

        char rightChar = str[windowEnd];

```

```

        if (charIndexMap.find(rightChar) != charIndexMap.end()) {

```

```

            windowStart = max(windowStart, charIndexMap[rightChar] + 1);

```

```

        }

```

```

        charIndexMap[rightChar] = windowEnd;

```

```

        maxLength = max(maxLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1);
    }
}

```



```

    }
    return maxLength;
}

```

Problem - Longest Substring with Same Letters after Replacement

Problem Statement

Given a string with lowercase letters only, if you are allowed to replace no more than 'k' letters with any letter, find the length of the longest substring having the same letters after replacement.

Example 1:

```

Input: String="aabccbb", k=2
Output: 5
Explanation: Replace the two 'c' with 'b' to have a longest repeating substring "bbbb".

```

```

#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std;

int findLength( string str, int k){
    int windowStart = 0;
    int maxLength = 0;
    int maxRepeatLetterCount = 0;
    unordered_map<char, int> letterFrequencyMap;
    for( int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < str.length(); windowEnd++){
        char rightChar = str[windowEnd];
        letterFrequencyMap[rightChar]++;
        maxRepeatLetterCount = max( maxRepeatLetterCount, letterFrequencyMap[rightChar]);
        if ( windowEnd - windowStart + 1 - maxRepeatLetterCount > k){
            char leftChar = str[windowStart];
            letterFrequencyMap[leftChar]--;
            windowStart++;
        }
        maxLength = max( maxLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1);
    }
    return maxLength;
}

```


Problem - Longest Subarray with Ones after Replacement.

Problem Statement

Given an array containing 0s and 1s, if you are allowed to replace no more than 'k' 0s with 1s, find the length of the longest contiguous subarray having all 1s.

Example 1:

Output: 6

Explanation: Replace the '0' at index 5 and 8 to have the longest contiguous subarray of 1s having length 6.

Example 2:

Input: Array=[0, 1, 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 1, 1], k=3

Output: 9

Explanation: Replace the '0' at index 6, 9, and 10 to have the longest contiguous subarray of 1s having length 9.

```
#include <iostream>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
int findLength( vector<int> &arr, int K) {
```

```
    int windowStart = 0;
```

```
    int maxLength = 0;
```

```
    int maxOnesCount = 0;
```

```
    // try to extend the range [windowStart, windowEnd]
```

```
    for( int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < arr.size(); windowEnd++) {
```

```
        if (arr[windowEnd] == 1) {
```

```
            maxOnesCount++;
```

```
        }
```

// current window size is from windowStart to windowEnd, overall we have a maximum of 1's repeating a maximum of 'maxOnesCount' times this means that we can have a window with 'maxOnesCount' 1s and the remaining are 0s which should replace with 1s.

// now, if the remaining 0s are more than 'K', it is the time to shrink the window as we are not allowed to replace more than 'K' 0s.

```
        if (windowEnd - windowStart + 1 - maxOnesCount > K) {
```

```
            if (arr[windowStart] == 1) {
```

```
                maxOnesCount--;
```

```
            }
```

```
            windowStart++;
```

```
        }
```

```
        maxLength = max(maxLength, windowEnd - windowStart + 1);
```

```
    }
```



```
    } return maxLength;
```

Problem - Permutation of a String ↴

example, "abc" has the following six permutations:

1. abc
2. acb
3. bac
4. bca
5. cab
6. cba

If a string has 'n' distinct characters it will have $n!$ permutations.

Example 1:

```
Input: String="oidbcaf", Pattern="abc"
Output: true
Explanation: The string contains "bca" which is a permutation of the given pattern.
```

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
class StringPermutation {
```

```
public:
```

```
    static bool findPermutation(string &str, string &pattern){
```

```
        int windowStart = 0;
```

```
        int matched = 0;
```

```
        unordered_map<char, int> charFrequencyMap;
```

```
        for(auto chr : pattern) {
```

```
            charFrequencyMap[chr]++;
```

```
        }
```

```
        for(int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < str.length(); windowEnd++){
```

```
            char rightChar = str[windowEnd];
```

```
            if(charFrequencyMap.find(rightChar) != charFrequencyMap.end()){
```

```
                charFrequencyMap[rightChar]--;
```

```
            if(charFrequencyMap[rightChar] == 0){
```

```
                matched--;
```

```
            }
```

```
            charFrequencyMap[leftChar]++;
```

```
        }
```

```
    }
```

```
}
```

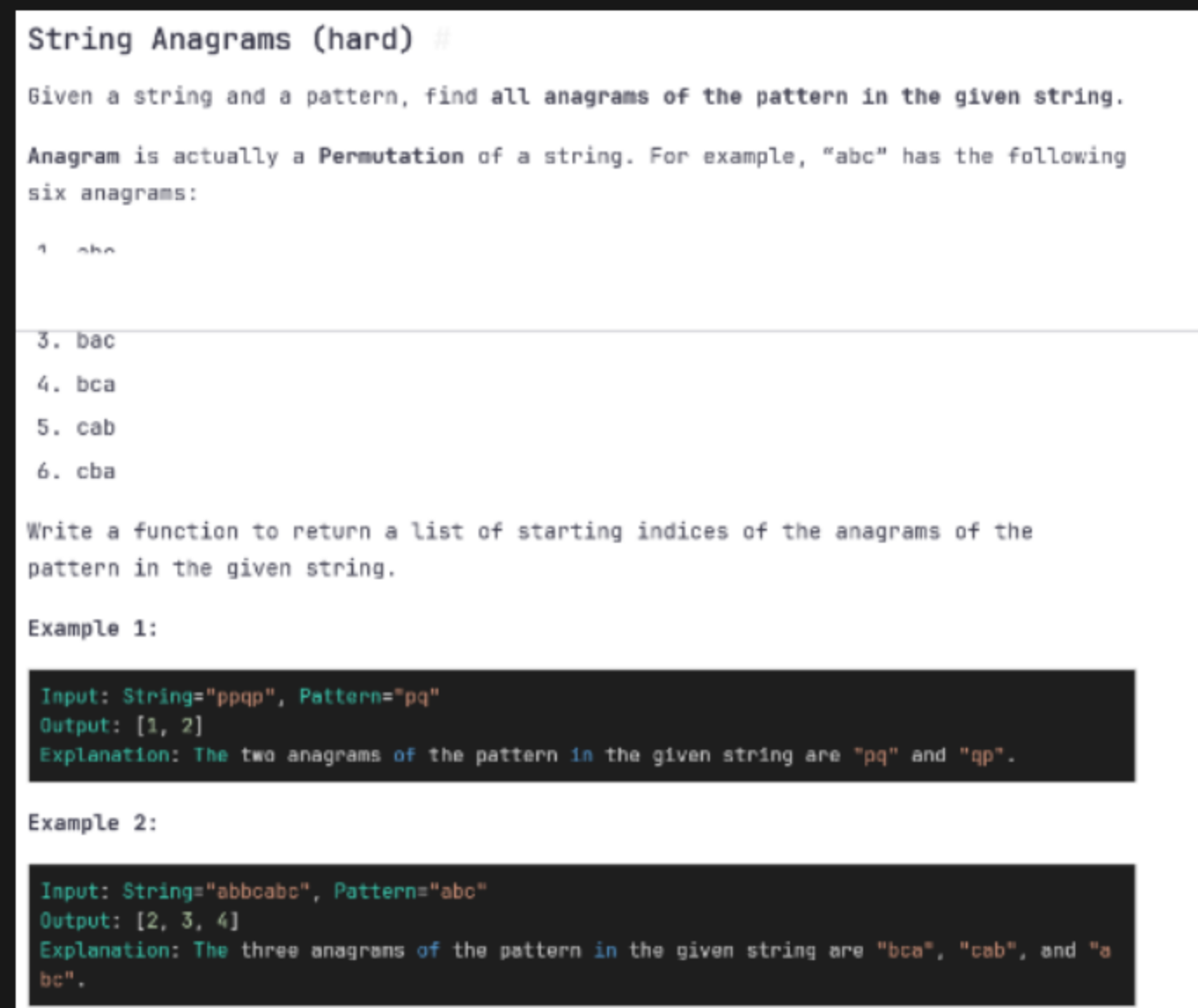


```

        return false;
    }
};

```

Problem - String Anagram.



```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
```

```
using namespace std;
```

```
class StringAnagrams {
```

```
public:
```

```
    static vector<int> findStringAnagram(string &str, string &pattern) {
```

```
        int windowStart = 0;
```

```
        int matched = 0;
```

```
        unordered_map<char, int> charFrequencyMap;
```

```
        for (auto chr : pattern) {
```

```
            charFrequencyMap[chr]++;
```

```
        }
```

```
        vector<int> resultIndices;
```

```
        for (int windowEnd = 0; windowEnd < str.length(); windowEnd++) {
```

```
            char rightChar = str[windowEnd];
```

```
            if (charFrequencyMap.find(rightChar) != charFrequencyMap.end()) {
```

```
                charFrequencyMap[rightChar]--;
```

```
                if (charFrequencyMap[rightChar] == 0) {
```



```

        matched++;
    }
}

if (match == (int) charFrequencyMap.size()) {
    resultIndices.push_back(windowStart);
}

if (windowEnd >= pattern.length() - 1) {
    char leftChar = str[windowStart++];
    if (charFrequencyMap.find(leftChar) != charFrequencyMap.end()) {
        if (charFrequencyMap[leftChar] == 0) {
            matched--;
        }
        charFrequencyMap[leftChar]++;
    }
}

return resultIndices;
};

```

Problem - Smallest Window containing Substring (hard)

Smallest Window containing Substring (hard)

Given a string and a pattern, find the smallest substring in the given string which has all the characters of the given pattern.

Example 1:

Input: String="aebdec", Pattern="abc"
 Output: "abdec"
 Explanation: The smallest substring having all characters of the pattern is "abdec"

Example 2:

Input: String="abdabca", Pattern="abc"
 Output: "abc"
 Explanation: The smallest substring having all characters of the pattern is "abc".

Example 3:

Input: String="adcad", Pattern="abc"
 Output: ""
 Explanation: No substring in the given string has all characters of the pattern.